HONG (IVY) ZHAN

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Website | GitHub | LinkedIn

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Credibility assessment, cross-platform information practices, and information access, with a focus on generative AI and participation in online communities.

EDUCATION

University of York, York, UK 2022 – 2024
MSc in Social Media and Management, with Merit
Selected coursework: Understanding Social Media; Social Media, Data & Society; Research Design.

Wuchang University of Technology, Wuhan, China 2017 – 2021
BEng in Computer Science and Technology
Selected coursework: Research Methods; Probability and Mathematical Statistics; Computer Networks.

MANUSCRIPTS

Zhan, H. (2026). Beyond the Aggregate: Trust and Distrust in Generative AI Across Technical Reddit Communities and Time. *Under review at Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW).* Sole author.
Preprint: SSRN | Data & code: Zenodo · GitHub

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Generative AI Trust and Distrust in Technical Reddit Communities
Sole-author research Feb 2026 – Oct 2026

- Found close pooled shares of *Neither* (neither trust nor distrust; 41.7%) and *Trust* (40.0%), with different community orderings: Trust led in r/ChatGPTCoding and r/programming; Neither led in r/webdev, r/GitHub, and r/compsci.
- Analyzed released data from five technical Reddit communities using Python and R, keeping 8,519 classification records separate from 4,964 dimension records.
- Examined how community, time, data provenance, and record availability affected the interpretation of trust-related discourse; distinguished discourse labels from individual attitudes.

Cross-Platform Social Media Use and Information Practices
MSc dissertation research | University of York Feb 2023 – Sep 2023

- Investigated how Chinese students in the UK used social media across platforms and evaluated information through 15 semi-structured interviews (approximately 60 minutes each).
- Transcribed interviews and coded them thematically in NVivo; analyzed social media posts to examine information practices and cultural adaptation.
- Identified cross-platform credibility checking, perceived media differences, and language barriers to participation, alongside platform-specific communication practices.

Recruitment Management System
BEng Graduation Thesis (Design) | Wuchang University of Technology Feb 2021 – Jun 2021

- Translated recruitment information workflows into interaction flows and a web-based system for job posting, application tracking, and candidate management using Spring Boot and MySQL.
- Evaluated recruitment workflows through think-aloud usability testing with 8 participants; used findings to guide interface revisions.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Strategy Analyst | TikTok Shop, London, UK Sep 2024 – Jan 2026

- Analyzed UK e-commerce performance across merchant growth, product operations, and content-driven sales; supported cross-functional business reviews and operational improvements.

Founder & Operations Manager | Zero Point HR, Wuhan, China Oct 2017 – Sep 2022

- Built a recruitment operations platform coordinating approximately 30 staff and matching job seekers with employers.
- Designed candidate-screening, shift-scheduling, and placement-tracking workflows supporting 3,000+ full-time placements and 100,000+ part-time shifts.

LEADERSHIP & SERVICE

Tech Volunteer | BetaNYC, New York, USA Jan 2026 – Mar 2026

- Engaged residents on barriers to accessing government information; prepared NYC public datasets and accessible visualizations for open-data and civic-tech workshops.

Data Volunteer | DataKind, London, UK Dec 2023 – Jul 2024

- Cleaned and analyzed nonprofit service data with Python/pandas in a DataDive; translated findings into visualizations and a stakeholder briefing to inform program decisions.

International Student Buddy | University of York, York, UK Oct 2022 – Sep 2023

- Mentored international students transitioning to university life, providing practical guidance and connecting them with campus resources and student communities.

RESEARCH METHODS & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Information research: Research design, semi-structured interviews, thematic analysis, NVivo.

Computational methods: Python (pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib), R, SQL, descriptive statistics, data visualization and provenance.

Human-centered systems: Requirements analysis, interaction design, Figma, think-aloud usability testing, web development, Spring Boot, MySQL.

Research workflow: Git/GitHub, LaTeX, data validation and reproducible analysis.

LANGUAGES

English (fluent); Chinese (native).

ACADEMIC REFERENCES

Prof. David Beer, Department of Sociology, University of York, Webpage.
Dr Bob Townley, School for Business and Society, University of York, Webpage.
James Lamont, FHEA, Department of Education, University of York, Webpage.